



WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The U.S. continued to** generate jobs at a steady pace in February, adding a seasonally adjusted 151,000 positions, but there were warning signs that the labor market could weaken. **A1**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks seesawed**, ending slightly higher on Friday, but down for the week. with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow industrials having fallen 3.1%, 3.45% and 2.4%, respectively. **B11**
- ◆ **The Fed's Powell** signaled the central bank was comfortable maintaining its current stance on interest rates as it digests the effects of changes to trade policy. **A2**
- ◆ **About \$900 million** in losses spread across two teams at Millennium Management contributed to its worst monthly performance in over six years in February. **B11**
- ◆ **Activist investor Mantle Ridge** has built a stake of more than \$1 billion in Cognizant and believes shares of the technology-services firm are undervalued. **B10**
- ◆ **A French former spy**master, Bernard Squarcini, was found guilty of illegally exploiting his networks to serve private interests, including those of LVMH and its chairman, Bernard Arnault. **B9**

World-Wide

- ◆ **A judge declined** to limit access to a Treasury Department payment system by Musk's Department of Government Efficiency, saying plaintiffs hadn't shown that improper disclosure of individuals' data was likely. **A4**
- ◆ **House Democratic leaders** said they would oppose a Republican measure to keep the government funded beyond March 14 and avoid a government shutdown. **A4**
- ◆ **The DHS said it would** no longer honor a bargaining agreement with the union representing airport security agents, a contract that covers more than 40,000 federal workers. **A2**
- ◆ **Gene Hackman died** of heart disease, officials in New Mexico said, and his wife, Betsy Arakawa, died of hantavirus pulmonary syndrome. **A6**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** canceled roughly \$400 million in federal grants and contracts to Columbia University, citing the school's alleged failure to protect Jewish students from discrimination. **A3**
- ◆ **The number of people** sickened by measles in Texas and New Mexico surpassed 200, more than doubling over the past two weeks. **A3**

NOONAN
Snap out of it, Democrats **A13**

CLOCKS GO FORWARD
Daylight-saving time begins in most of the U.S. and Canada at 2 a.m. Sunday. Clocks move ahead by one hour. Standard time returns on Sunday, Nov. 2.

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U.S. Threatens Sanctions as Russia Slams Ukraine



SMOLDERING: A car burned in Kharkiv after Russia bombarded Ukrainian cities with missiles and attack drones on Friday. President Trump said he was 'strongly considering' imposing sanctions and tariffs on Russia until a peace deal is reached. **A8**

Trump Goes All In for Crypto After His \$Trump Epiphany

President Trump regaled a group of high-rollers visiting Mar-a-Lago about all his administration was doing for

By Rebecca Ballhaus, Josh Dawsey and Eliza Collins

the cryptocurrency industry. Then he turned to all the crypto money he is making as president. Trump's personal meme coin, which he launched days

before his inauguration, could bring in billions of dollars, the president said with an air of amazement. At one point, he turned to the audience—a group of donors who had each paid \$1 million to his super PAC—and asked whether they knew what \$Trump was worth. One did, according to people who were at the March 1 gathering. It had a market cap of around \$13 billion. The success of \$Trump is one of the starkest examples

of the president benefiting from an industry his administration regulates. Trump, who promised to be the nation's "first crypto president," recounted to the group the Securities and Exchange Commission's recent dismissal of cases against crypto companies, nearly a dozen by Friday. Crypto executives see that as evidence of the industry's liberation from regulatory threats under the Biden administration that limited its

growth in the U.S. Other Mar-a-Lago guests that night included David Sacks, a longtime investor who now leads Trump's cryptocurrency policy. Sacks said this week he had sold his crypto holdings and his company had divested its stakes in certain crypto startups. A representative for Sacks didn't respond to a question about whether his firm retained investments in any crypto start-ups. *Please turn to page A10*

FTX Founder Makes Play For Pardon

After the spectacular collapse of his cryptocurrency exchange, Sam Bankman-Fried opened a Google Doc and started brainstorming a plan to resuscitate his public image.

By Ben Cohen, Alexander Osipovich and James Fanelli

"These are all random probably bad ideas," wrote the FTX founder. The collection of 19 bullet points ranged from portraying himself as "extremely pro crypto, pro freedom" to sending out a poll on Twitter soliciting advice. But it was No. 3 on the disgraced mogul's list of strategies that looked like the most improbable suggestion of them all: going on Tucker Carlson's show and coming out as a Republican.

Coming from one of the largest donors to the Democratic Party, it was a brazen thought—as if the crypto kingpin famous for his unruly frizz suddenly decided to get a buzzcut.

In the memo to himself, which federal prosecutors introduced ahead of his sentencing, Bankman-Fried plotted out exactly how he would pull it off. He would shine a light *Please turn to page A6*

NATO's Baltic Target: Sea-Cable Saboteurs

By BOJAN PANCEVSKI AND DANIEL MICHAELS

Just after midnight on Dec. 26, Finnish commandos dropped from two helicopters onto the deck of a ramshackle Russian oil tanker in the Baltic Sea and ordered the ship's crew to sail into port. They were acting on the orders of Finnish officials who suspected the Eagle S had hours earlier dragged its anchor along the seabed to slice through a vital power cable between Finland and Estonia. The Finnish action also potentially prevented the ship from cutting

another cable, officials said. It was the latest incident of suspected sabotage involving ships carrying Russian cargo in the region, and the first time authorities boarded a suspicious vessel while it was under way. Then came the real work: Finding the evidence to prove sabotage. Finnish law-enforcement officials questioned the crew *Please turn to page A8*

- ◆ **U.S. threatens more sanctions on Russia..... A8**
- ◆ **Germany considers nuclear options for defense..... A8**

Border Towns Question BFF Status

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U.S.-Canada feud makes it weird; 'Just a little hurt'

By JOE BARRETT

INTERNATIONAL FALLS, Minn.—This Northern Minnesota town is famous for its giant Smokey Bear statue, its cold weather and a cheeky nickname—"Icebox of the Nation."

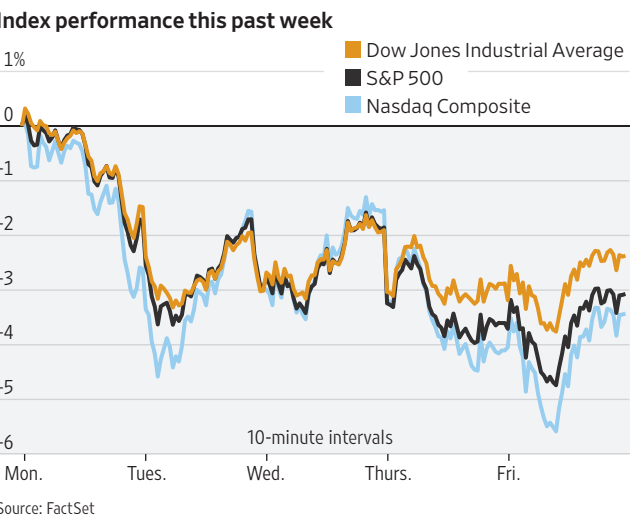
Less well-known is that it has a twin, Fort Frances, Ont. *Please turn to page A10*

EXCHANGE

DELIVERY WAR
Walmart's surprising challenge to Amazon's online supremacy. **B1**

Stocks Rise to Cap Rough Week

Major indexes finished slightly higher Friday but were down for the week amid concern about unpredictable tariff policies. **B11**



It's Now Time to Debate Daylight-Saving Time

By JUSTIN LAHART

Most people in the U.S. will be setting their clocks forward on Sunday, an annual ritual that allows them to start fighting about daylight-saving time an hour earlier. The experience—interrupted sleep, tired children—is so distasteful that in recent years there have been growing calls to get rid of the clock change altogether. President Trump has seized on the cause. "The Republican Party will use its best efforts to eliminate Daylight Saving Time, which has a small but strong constituency, but

shouldn't!" he wrote in a post on Truth Social in December. (He had a different position a few years earlier, tweeting in 2019 that "Making Daylight Saving Time permanent is O.K. with me!") Economists have jumped into the debate. Daylight-saving time's original selling point was to reduce energy use by making sunsets later in the day. New research questions that claim. Preliminary findings from Yale economist Matthew Kotchen, with Arianna Salazar-Miranda, Erin Mansur and Steve Cicala, suggest that in *Please turn to page A6*